

2026-10-04 02:48:58

- Agreed, those were too terse. Here's a plain-English version, written to read like a simple question and a short answer:

```
"userConfig": {
  "max_entries": {
    "type": "number",
    "title": "How many messages to keep in the full history",
    "description": "full.html keeps this many messages. When a new one comes in past the limit, the oldest is deleted.
Default: 500.",
    "default": 500, "min": 1
  },
  "first_entries": {
    "type": "number",
    "title": "How many messages to save from the start of a session",
    "description": "The first messages of a session are saved in first-N.md and never deleted. After compaction, they are
used to recall the original goal. Default: 10.",
    "default": 10, "min": 1
  },
  "last_entries": {
    "type": "number",
    "title": "How many recent messages to save",
    "description": "The most recent messages are saved in last-N.md. Each new message pushes out the oldest. After
compaction, they are used to recall the latest work. Default: 10.",
    "default": 10, "min": 1
  }
}
```

- What changed
- **Titles are questions** ("How many..."), so you know what number to type.
 - **Each description has the same three parts:** what is saved, what happens at the limit, and why it matters.
 - **Dropped jargon:** "rolling", "trimmed" and "entries" are gone; it says "messages", "deleted" and "pushes out" instead.
 - **Default shown in the text,** so you don't need to remember it.

One thing to know: each limit applies separately to your messages ([requests/](#)) and to the replies ([responses/](#)). So 500 means 500 of each, not 500 in total. I left this out of the descriptions to keep them short, but I can add "(applies to your messages and replies separately)" if you'd like it to be explicit.

Nothing is applied yet. Want me to implement it with this wording, along with the [save.sh](#) change and the end-to-end test?

Confidence: 90%. The JSON uses only fields from the docs ([type](#), [title](#), [description](#), [default](#), [min](#)), and [claude plugin validate](#) will confirm it. The other 10% is whether the long titles fit cleanly in the [/config](#) panel. I can't see that until it's installed, so if they get cut off I'll shorten them.

- One-liners
- **Problem:** the titles and descriptions were too short and full of jargon.
 - **Fix:** question-style titles, plus descriptions that say what, what happens at the limit, and why, with the default included.
 - **Open question:** whether to say the limits apply to messages and replies separately.

TL;DR: I rewrote the 3 settings in plain English with question-style titles and the defaults in the text. Say go and I'll implement and test it.

- Yes. Claude Code plugins have an official setting for this called `userConfig`, and it fits this case well. I checked it in the [plugin manifest reference](#).

What the docs confirm

- **Number settings with defaults and bounds:** `plugin.json` can declare `userConfig` options with `"type": "number"`, a `default`, and `min/max` limits.
- **Users get asked:** Claude Code asks for the values when the plugin is enabled. Each value also appears as a row in `/config` (Claude Code v2.1.269 or later), so users can change it later.
- **Hooks can read the values:** each value is passed to hook processes as `CLAUDE_PLUGIN_OPTION_<KEY>`. Our hooks run as shell commands, so `save.sh` can just read `$CLAUDE_PLUGIN_OPTION_MAX_ENTRIES`.
- **Where values are saved:** under `pluginConfigs` in the user's `settings.json`.

Proposed change (not applied yet)

`plugin.json`:

```
"userConfig": {
  "max_entries": { "type": "number", "title": "Entries kept in full.html", "description": "Oldest are removed past this",
"default": 500, "min": 1 },
  "first_entries": { "type": "number", "title": "Entries in first-N.md",      "description": "Session's opening turns, never
trimmed", "default": 10, "min": 1 },
  "last_entries": { "type": "number", "title": "Entries in last-N.md",      "description": "Rolling latest turns",
"default": 10, "min": 1 }
}
```

`save.sh`: replace the 3 fixed numbers:

```
max_entries=${CLAUDE_PLUGIN_OPTION_MAX_ENTRIES:-500}
first_entries=${CLAUDE_PLUGIN_OPTION_FIRST_ENTRIES:-10}
last_entries=${CLAUDE_PLUGIN_OPTION_LAST_ENTRIES:-10}
```

The `:-500` fallback covers the case where the value isn't set. The docs don't say clearly whether the default is passed when the user never saves a value, so the fallback avoids depending on that.

Edge cases this change has to handle:

1. **File names include the number:** the files are named `first-10.md` and `last-10.md`, so changing a setting changes the file name. `last-*` files already get renamed for this. `first-*` files need the same rename.
2. **Lowering a setting:** a new limit only takes effect the next time an entry is saved. At that point `full.html` and `last-N.md` are trimmed to the new limit. `first-N.md` would keep its extra entries, because that file only ever grows, so it would need a one-time trim.
3. **README and SKILL.md:** both need to say these values can be changed in `/config`.

`recall.sh` needs no change, because it already finds `first-*` and `last-*` files whatever the number is.

How I'd test it end to end

Set the variables to small values (`MAX=3`, `FIRST=2`, `LAST=2`) on a copy of a real session and run `save.sh` 5 times. Then check:

- the entry count in each file,
- that the files were renamed,
- that the page still renders in Chrome.

After that, `claude plugin validate .` checks the manifest. The `/config` row itself can only be confirmed after you install the update.

Want me to implement it?

Confidence: 90%.

- **Confident about:** the `userConfig` fields, the `CLAUDE_PLUGIN_OPTION_<KEY>` variable and the `/config` rows. All three are quoted from the official docs.
- **Not confirmed:** whether the default is passed when the user never saves a value (the fallback handles it either way), and whether your Claude Code version is v2.1.269 or later, which the `/config` row needs. To get to 100%, run `claude --version`, then after installing, open `/config` and look for the 3 rows.

One-liners

- **Question:** can users choose the 500 / 10 / 10 limits?
- **Today:** no, they're fixed in `save.sh`.
- **Solution:** the official plugin `userConfig` setting, with values shown in `/config` and read through `CLAUDE_PLUGIN_OPTION_*`.
- **Code change:** 3 options in `plugin.json`, 3 lines in `save.sh`, a `first-*` rename and trim, and doc updates.
- **Source:** the official plugin manifest reference, not memory.

TL;DR: Yes. Adding `userConfig` to `plugin.json` lets users set all three limits in `/config`, and `save.sh` reads them from environment variables. It's a small change. Say go and I'll build and test it.